VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

Oyster mushroom

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-11

Needs no land and little capital, which suits a first try. Hygiene and finding a steady buyer matter most; fresh mushrooms spoil fast.

DIFFICULTY	MONEY NEEDED	RISK	FIRST RETURN
2 of 5	**Low**	**Medium**	**about 3-4 weeks from spawning**

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

In this guide

- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

Your land at a glance

What you would need to build

A shaded, well-ventilated room or shed; no land needed. Plains: roughly October to March when temperature is 20-30 C; hills: March to October (ICAR NEH). Outside that window you need cooling or must wait.

Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

1. Build only after you have seen one working
Visit or train with an operating unit before you spend money on a room, equipment or planting material. (general knowledge)

2. Talk to your KVK first
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

3. Start small
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

4. Line up a buyer before you scale
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

Your planting plan for 1 acre

What	How much	Basis
Example starter batch (bags)	**20**	an example, not a recommendation
Spawn (about 250 g for every 2 bags, so about 125 g per bag)	**2,500 g**	your plot size x cited amounts [S2]

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

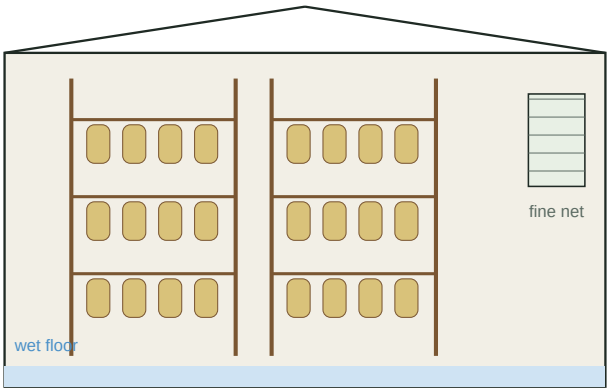
Planting material

- Buy tested spawn from ICAR-DMR Solan, an ICAR institute or agricultural university, or a reliable private spawn lab. About one 250 g packet of spawn is enough for 2 bags of 60 x 45 cm. [S2, S4]
- Use fresh spawn and use it quickly; old or contaminated spawn is the most common cause of failure. (general knowledge)

Land preparation and planting

- Substrate: paddy or wheat straw, chopped. Paddy straw reached a biological efficiency of about 77 percent at ICAR-CIARI; wheat straw can do better. [S2, S5]
- Pasteurise or sterilise the chopped straw with heat (hot water or steam) before filling bags; do not use chemical dips. Ask your KVK for the exact time and temperature they recommend. [S2]

- Fill transparent bags (about 60 x 45 cm), layer spawn with straw, tie, make a few small holes, and hang or rack the bags in a dark, clean, well-aerated room. [S1, S2]



dark, clean, ventilated room; 20-30 C; humidity 70-90 percent

A simple growing room

Irrigation

- No watering of the bags until pinheads form; keep the room humid by sprinkling walls and floor. [S1]
- Once fruiting starts, light misting keeps the surface moist; avoid soaking the bags. (general knowledge)

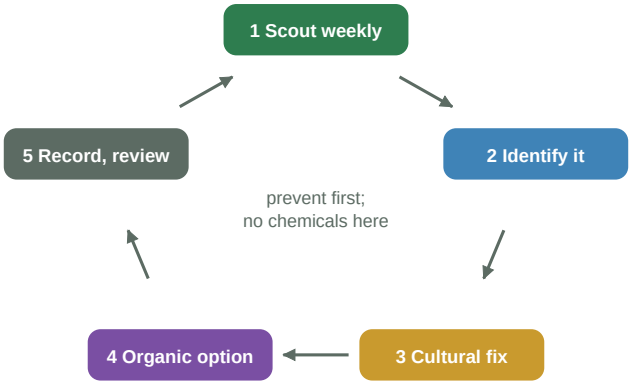
Nutrition (organic)

- The straw is the food; no added fertiliser is needed. Used (spent) substrate can be composted afterwards. (general knowledge)

Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- During spawn run keep 20-28 C and about 85 percent humidity; remove any bag showing contamination immediately. [S4]
- Neem leaf extract has been tested as an organic biocontrol in oyster mushroom beds at an ICAR centre, with higher yield; ask your KVK how to use it. [S6]
- Keep the room clean, wash hands and tools, keep flies out with fine net on windows, and do not store old bags or straw nearby. (general knowledge)

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)



Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review

Monitoring

- Check daily: temperature, humidity, white mycelium spreading, any green, black or orange patches (contamination), and pinhead formation. (general knowledge)
- Spawn run takes 15-20 days; flushes come about 10 days apart, 3-4 flushes per crop. [S1, S4]

Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- Harvest each flush when the caps are fully formed but before the edges curl; twist and pull gently. (general knowledge)
- An ICAR-CIARI example: about Rs 59,000 investment for 20 quintals of straw over 12 months, with gross returns around Rs 85,000 from 5 crops. This is a regional illustration; prices and costs change. [S2]
- Sell fresh the same day where possible; mushrooms can also be dried. [S4]

Risks and costs

- Contamination can wipe out a batch; start with a few bags and learn before scaling. (general knowledge)
- Fresh mushrooms are perishable, so secure a nearby buyer or market first. (general knowledge)

If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Heat** (fixable): Above about 30 C, growth and quality fall. Grow in the cooler months, or use a thick-walled shed with wet gunny cloth on the walls and floor sprinkling to bring the temperature down. (general knowledge)
- **Dry air** (fixable): Keep room humidity at 70-90 percent by sprinkling water on walls and floor (not on the bags). [S1, S3]

About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of

any registered product.

Sources

[S1] https://morungexpress.com/oyster-mushroom-cultivation
[S2] https://ciari.icar.gov.in/oyster_mushroom.html
[S3] https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/MR/article/download/116503/46254/499209
[S4] https://cpcri.icar.gov.in/filemgr/webfs/publication/extfldrno251.pdf
[S5] https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/MR/article/download/116503/46254/499209
[S6] https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/MR/article/download/111664/45321/500215

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